

Introduction

Do you feel completely unprepared for adulthood? Do you plan on just asking your parents about your health insurance or how to fill out a tax form? If so, you're in the right place. This book is for people who feel like fools but do not want to feel like fools any longer. While many of you may be able to execute a five-paragraph essay, recite the formula for the quadratic equation, or recall every useless quote from your favorite Netflix show, the vast majority of Americans enter adulthood ignorant to real-world finances. Do not panic. These topics are much easier to understand than they seem, and by the end of this book you will be ready to take them on.

Whether you are a recent high school graduate, current college student, or young professional pretending to know what you are doing, this book simplifies the often daunting aspects of life that come with being an adult: interest, basic banking, paying for college, budgeting, credit, credit cards, taxes, investing, retirement, insurance, and buying a car and home. This book does not promise to make you millions of dollars or explain how to beat the stock market, but it will provide you with a foundation in personal